

The Prisoner and the Podcasters

Ross made his choice. Now the libertarians have to make theirs.

He said that five times in a speech to a Bitcoin conference. He gave it over a collect call from a maximum security penitentiary.

Every few minutes an automated voice cut in over him:

THIS CALL IS FROM A FEDERAL PRISON.

He told them about the hole...

He once spent four months straight in there. He had air... stale and foul, but air. Food through a slot in the door. Other than that, it was just a lifeless hole.

And the hole wasn't the worst of it. It was the knowing that even once you're out of the hole, you're still not free... and you never will be again.

He was given two life sentences plus 40 years, with no chance for parole.

This is hell.

You can't even escape it in your dreams, when you sleep...

"In the dream I was free. I was in a park, and I felt this huge relief... and then the anxiety just woke me up. And there I was again, in the hole... Life without parole. Maximum security. There's no end in sight."

He knew what talking to that crowd might cost him. He told them so.

"I'm afraid that because of what I'm saying to you today, I'll be thrown in the hole, or worse."

He was right. That's exactly what they did.

His name is Ross Ulbricht.

In September, he stood on a Republican stage and told his fellow libertarians exactly where he stands. They don't want you to hear it.

~ Clay



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Type the address, or scan the code.

When you're done, hand this to a friend.